

SCORE
BOARD

Performance of the OCR Packages

Name	Contact	Price	Accuracy and Formatting (%)								Overall*	Rating
			Laser	Photocopying	Dot matrix	Typing	Fax	Table	Newspapers	Magazine		
Cognitive CuneiForm 99	www.ocr.com	Rs 6,000	83.45	80.41	83.75	68.48	0.00	90.10	45.00	35.00	74.86	B
Abbyy FineReader 5.0 Pro	Vikmans Multimedia, Phone: 011-6472325, E-mail: manish@vikmans.com, www.abbyy.com	Rs 5,000	93.25	92.54	92.72	99.57	80.93	98.83	92.50	97.50	90.93	A
ScanSoft OmniPage Pro 10	Sonata, Phone: 022-4943055, www.scansoft.com	NA	73.96	75.72	89.03	99.78	0.00	95.20	97.50	99.00	83.81	A-
ParaVision PageGenie Pro	www.pagegenie.com	Rs 4,700	67.36	67.27	78.64	71.09	11.18	44.76	30.00	55.00	65.47	B-
Newsoft Presto! OCR Pro 4.0	www.newsoftinc.com	Rs 4,700	88.74	89.22	91.91	99.57	0.90	99.67	75.00	92.50	84.98	A-
ReadIris Pro 6.0	www.irislink.com	Rs 6,500	86.45	82.15	63.30	49.13	0.00	93.25	20.00	77.50	73.53	B
Recognita Plus 5.0	www.recognita.hu	NA	83.43	83.40	77.50	0.00	0.00	96.75	77.50	95.00	80.08	A-
TextBridge Pro Millennium	www.scansoft.com	Rs 3,700	91.14	90.39	89.90	99.13	49.22	97.67	45.00	97.00	89.74	A
Expervision Typereader 6.0	www.expervision.com	Rs 11,700	82.44	88.72	89.78	99.13	0.00	99.00	75.00	40.00	76.41	B+
Wocar 2.5	http://persoweb.france.net.fr/~cambien	Free	81.17	82.48	54.76	46.52	0.00	44.76	15.00	15.00	56.31	C+

*The Overall score is the sum of the weighted results in the accuracy and formatting tests as also a reflection of the features

CONCLUSION

As evident, in terms of overall performance, **FineReader** scores with good performance in all the tests. It's among the few software that could recognise superscripts, and had the best accuracy in the fax test as well as the magazine that had reverse text. FineReader also came out tops as far as retaining layout goes and at Rs 5,000 is quite reasonably priced.

TextBridge Pro came very close with a good feature list that is mind-boggling and even gets overbearing at times. It also



managed a fair bit of accuracy

in the fax test and recognised the text in reverse. Even Presto! OCR, which is based on the FineReader OCR engine, gave a

good performance. Wocar was the only software that came for free, but apart from the laser printout test, its performance is nothing worth writing about and it had the least scores. We did expect a lot from OmniPage Pro, and it did quite well in the magazines and newspapers test as far as recognition capabilities is concerned. A new version, OmniPage Pro 11, has recently been released and it is said to have an enhanced OCR engine along with support for converting PDFs to text documents while retaining layouts, so that's something you can wait for. 

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